

Sophia Ruger

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COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Data Analysis:** Cartographic Visualization, Data Cleaning, Statistical Methods, Programming.
- **Project Management:** Communication, Presentations (Adobe, Powerpoint), Organization, and Leadership.
- **Research:** Social and Behavioral (IRB certified), annotated bibliographies (Zotero), and active reading.
- **Software:** ArcGIS Pro (Geographic Information System), Python, R Studio, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Drive.
- **Communication:** Excellent written and verbal skills, report preparation, presentation and collaboration with private and public entities.
- **Public Engagement:** Engaging diverse communities, large meetings and public events.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Director of Sustainability, Martin Hammond, Undergraduate Student Government **July 2025 – May 2026**

- Developed legislation to reduce waste and improve student life on Arizona State University's (ASU) Tempe campus.
- Organized events for student groups, including the Student Made event which generated \$365 per hour in profit for student entrepreneurs.
- Collaborated with student and faculty organizations to relaunch the ASU Sustainability Summit.

Geographic Information System (GIS) Intern, Connor Sheehan, Christina Ngo, Social Embeddedness **April 2025 – May 2026**

- Analyzed 5,000 intake points at over 30 women's shelter locations throughout the State of Arizona.
- Cleaned and managed Maricopa County Animal Control's activity and licensing data, including over 200,000 data points.
- Completed four presentations and facilitated collaborative communications with community partners.
- Co-hosted geospatial dashboard workshops for over 30 employees of four food banks throughout the State of Arizona.

Intern, Garden Habitats of Arizona, Kelli Larson, CAP REU at ASU **May 2024 – Sept 2025**

- Geolocated over 4,300 data entries, analyzed trends and anomalies over specific time period.
- Collaborated with the Arizona Wildlife Federation to author a blog series ([AWF](#)).
- Created three poster displays, highlighting important work and engaging viewers in professional presentations.

Hostess and Server, Social Hall Tempe **July 2024 – Dec 2024**

- Welcomed over 100 guests per shift, attended to phone orders and provided attentive table service to dining room guests.

Research Assistant, Human-Wildlife Coexistence, Kelli Larson, SURE at ASU **Jan 2024 – May 2024**

- Conducted a literature review of urban coyote research using Zotero.
- Presented social science solutions and analysis at the Central Arizona-Phoenix, Long Term Ecological Research Symposia.

Eco Representative, Paige Strickland, ASU **Sept 2023 – April 2024**

- Educated over 1,000 students about sustainable practices; planned, promoted, and co-hosted 20 events.
- Manage social media and create engaging science communication material using Adobe and Canva.

Server and Line Cook, Deno's Pizzeria, Lake Oswego, OR **May 2023 – Aug 2023**

- Provided food and beverage service to over 50 customers per shift, attended to phone customer and dining room service.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Treasurer, WakeDevils Club, ASU Athletics **Oct 2022 – Present**

- Raised over \$5,000 in funds for annual competition, managed team finances, and recruited new members.

Member, Campus Student Sustainability Initiatives at ASU **Nov 2022 – Nov 2024**

- Organize "Really Really Free Market" initiative, provided living necessities to the Tempe, AZ community residents.

Teaching Assistant, Patrick Connolly, Lakeridge High School **May 2021 – June 2021**

- Developed education material for a sustainable agriculture unit for Ecology and Conservation class.

EDUCATION

Sustainability BS, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona

Graduating May 2026, Summa Cum Laude

Relevant coursework: Research Skills, Systems Thinking, Landscapes and Sustainability, Ecosystems

Geographic Information Science BS, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona
Relevant Coursework: Programming II, GIS for Climate Change Science, GIS III

Graduating May 2026, *Summa Cum Laude*

Urban Planning Minor, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona
Relevant coursework: Transportation & Environmental Planning, Urban Design

Graduating May 2026, *Summa Cum Laude*

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EDUCATION

Geographic Information Science, Bachelor of Science
Sustainability, Bachelor of Science
Urban Planning, Minor

2022 - 2026 (Expected)

Arizona State University, Tempe | Barrett, the Honors College
GPA: 3.95/3.95

Honors Thesis: An Exploration of the National Wildlife Federation Habitat Certification Program © in Arizona

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Thesis Applied Experience

Arizona State University, Tempe

Central Arizona-Phoenix Long Term Ecological Research (CAP LTER)

May 2024 – Dec 2025

- Geolocate over 4,300 data entries in ArcGIS Pro, analyzing temporal and spatial trends.
- Review relevant literature and apply research methods.
- Collaborate with partners such as the Arizona Wildlife Federation to develop community outreach techniques.

Ruger, S., Trgovac, A. B., Larson, K. L. (2025). *An Exploration of the National Wildlife Federation Habitat Certification Program © in Arizona* [Undergraduate honors thesis, Arizona State University].

Geographic Information Science Student Researcher

Arizona State University, Tempe

Social Embeddedness

April 2025 – Present

- Analyze usage at 30 Women's Shelter locations across Arizona by cleaning and managing datasets with over 5,000 collective entries.
- Recommend community support to Maricopa County Animal Control based on a Hot Spot Analysis of aggressive animals and low owner licensing.

Ruger, S., Vogel, A., Ngo, C., Sheehan, C. (2025). *Where Arizona Women Seek Help: Data-Informed Insights for Hope Women's Center*. Hope Women's Center, Arizona State University. [Internal Report]

Human-Wildlife Coexistence Research Assistant

Arizona State University, Tempe

Sustainability Undergraduate Research Experience (SURE)

Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Conducted a literature review of urban coyote research and crafted an annotated bibliography.
- Held qualitative interviews that integrated learned research methods to code language.

Larson, K. L., Trgovac, A. B., **Ruger, S.** (2025). *Wildlife Garden Whereabouts: Geospatial and Temporal Trends of Certified Habitats in Arizona*. Arizona Wildlife Federation, Arizona State University. [Blog]

Project Cities

Arizona State University, Tempe

ASU Sustainable Cities Network

Aug 2023 – Nov 2023

- Provided research-backed solutions to complex municipal challenges in Chandler’s Urban Parks System.

PRESENTATIONS

Ruger, S., Flores, A., Vogel, A., Ngo, C., Sheehan, C. (2026, February 10). *Geolocating High Activity Rates and Low Licensing Rates of Dog Owners in Maricopa County* [Powerpoint Presentation]. Social Embeddedness Network at ASU, Maricopa County Animal Care and Control, Tempe, AZ, USA.

Ruger, S., Trgovac, A. B., Larson, K. L. (2025, August 6). *Certified Wildlife Habitats in Arizona* [Powerpoint Presentation]. Central Arizona-Phoenix Long Term Ecological Research: Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU), Tempe, AZ, USA.

Ruger, S., Vogel, A., Ngo, C., Sheehan, C. (2025, May 29). *Informing the Future: a Quantitative Analysis of Hope Women’s Center Usage* [Powerpoint Presentation]. Social Embeddedness Network at ASU, Hope Women’s Center, Tempe, AZ, USA.

Ruger, S., Trgovac, A. B., Larson, K. L. (2025, January 17). *Geospatial and Temporal Trends of Wildlife Gardening in Arizona & Metro Phoenix* [Poster Presentation]. CAP LTER All Scientists Meeting and Poster Symposium, Tempe AZ, USA.

Ruger, S., Cegielski, L., Kapur, S., Larson K. L. (2024, April 26). *Human Attitudes and Interactions with Coyotes and Raccoons* [Poster Presentation]. Sustainability Undergraduate Research Experience Poster Session, Tempe, AZ, USA.

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND HONORS

Leadership Scholarship (\$1,250)

Fall 2025 *Arizona State University Undergraduate Student Government*

New American University Provost Scholarship (\$12,000 annually)

Fall 2022 – Spring 2026 *Arizona State University*

SUN Award (x4)

Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026 *Arizona State University*

Dean’s List

Fall 2022 – Fall 2025 *Arizona State University*

CAMPUS AND COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Director of Sustainability

Undergraduate Student Government

Tempe, AZ

July 2025 – Present

Treasurer

ASU WakeDevils

Tempe, AZ

Aug 2025 – Present

Eco Representative

University Sustainability Practices

Tempe, AZ

Sept 2023 – April 2024

Club Member

Campus Student Sustainability Initiatives (CSSI)

Tempe, AZ

Fall 2022 – Fall 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Food Bank Dashboard Workshop

Arizona State University

- Co-presented and developed a training workshop for staff from all four of Arizona's major food bank networks on a geospatial dashboard developed to address food insecurity.
- Developed training materials including a participant handout and assisted in leading hands-on activities.
- Funded by the Arizona Board of Regents and covered by ASU News. Received digital credential for participation.

Conservation Curriculum Independent Study

Lakeridge High School

- Created and presented content for my Ecology and Conservation class as an independent study credit over a two week period in 2020.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Spatial Data Analysis: ArcGIS Pro, Google Earth Pro
- Data Visualization: Powerpoint, Story Maps, Poster Presentations
- Programming: Python, R, VS Code, R Studio, Excel
- Research: Social and Behavioral (IRB certified), active reading and annotations

PORTFOLIO

Request access to my portfolio [here](#).